SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA

A VISUAL RESEARCH ON STUDENTS' REPRESENTATION OF PEACE

A Thesis Presented To
The Faculty of
College of Teacher Education

In Partial Requirements for the Degree
BACHELOR OF SECONDARY EDUCATION MAJOR IN SOCIAL STUDIES

By

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SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA
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ABSTRACT

TITLE:	A Visual Research on Students' Representation of Peace
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QUALITATIVE VISUAL RESEARCH DESIGN

I. OBJECTIVES

This study aims to understand how 2nd year Criminology students view and express peace through their drawings and explanations, focusing on the symbols, themes, and ideas in their artworks to provide insights for improving peace education programs.

II. METHODOLOGY

This study used a qualitative visual method where second-year Criminology students created drawings of peace and explained them in interviews. The researchers analyzed these drawings and explanations to identify common themes and meanings, allowing a deeper understanding of how students personally experience and express peace.

III. FINDINGS

IV. RECOMMENDATIONS

KEYWORDS:

DEDICATION

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CHAPTER 1

THE PROBLEM AND ITS SCOPE

1.1 Background of the study

Peace is commonly understood as more than the absence of war or direct violence; it is a dynamic and context-based concept that includes justice, respect, and harmonious relationships within society (Galtung, 2021). Scholars highlight that peace involves cognitive, emotional, and social dimensions, shaped by cultural realities, environmental responsibility, and shared human values (Mabunga, 2021; Smieszek, 2022). In educational settings, peace is often experienced and expressed through everyday interactions, where unity, empathy, and inclusion are practiced rather than merely taught (Jabor & Palmos, 2025; Sapao & Dacles, 2021). The meaning of peace also varies across social and historical contexts, as seen in post-conflict societies such as Sri Lanka, Cambodia, and South Africa (Olivius & Åkebo, 2021). Taken together, these perspectives suggest that peace is not a single idea, but a lived experience that can be expressed in many forms, including visual representations, which reflect how individuals and communities understand and imagine peace.

In the Philippines, visual and public art has long been a meaningful way to express ideas about peace, social concerns, and shared values. Studies show that community-based and collaborative art practices help raise awareness of human rights and social issues by encouraging participation and dialogue (University of the Philippines, 2024). In school settings, learners communicate their understanding of peace and conflict through drawings, posters, and other visual forms, which reflect their emotions, experiences, and cultural backgrounds (Paterson, 2024). For example, in classrooms, students use symbols, colors, and short texts to represent themes such as unity, justice, and cooperation, allowing teachers to integrate these expressions into discussions, activities, and reflections on social responsibility. These practices show that

school policies and programs on peace education are not only theoretical but directly guide learners' behavior, decision-making, and understanding of social values, helping students apply peace-oriented principles in both classroom and community contexts (Blasch & Thoma, 2024; Lokola, 2024; Anderson, 2024).

Moreover, Saint Michael College of Caraga develops criminology students not only academically but also in values such as peace, justice, and social harmony. However, there is limited understanding of how these students visually express peace. Research shows that visual art, such as drawings, can communicate complex ideas and emotions that words alone cannot fully convey (Cengelci Kose & Gurdogan Bayir, 2016).

Studies of youth drawings highlight three main themes. First, symbols and colors reflect perceptions of conflict, harmony, and social relationships (Güleç, 2021). Second, emotional expression allows learners to show feelings of hope, resilience, and unity through their artworks (Visions of peace, 2024). Third, community and social themes help students explore ideas of nature, social justice, and wellbeing, showing how peace is practiced and experienced in their environment (Lokola, 2024; Anderson, 2024).

Most studies have focused on children or adolescents, leaving a gap in knowledge about college students, particularly in criminology, and how they visually represent or explain peace. This study examines these visual expressions to understand students' perspectives and to support peace-oriented practices in higher education.

Therefore, this study uses the Interactive Peace Imagery (IPI) framework by Möller and Bellmer (2023) to understand how students show peace through drawings and simple stories. It looks at the symbols they choose and the meanings they give to them. While previous research has mostly focused on children or adolescents, there is limited understanding of how college

students, especially in criminology, visually express peace. By examining their drawings and reflections, this study aims to fill this gap and provide new insights into how students think about peace based on both their school learning and real-life experiences.

This study will benefit various stakeholders, particularly the students, teachers, and school administration. It allows students to gain a deeper understanding of how to express their ideas and emotions about peace through visual art, helping them reflect on personal and social values. Teachers can use the findings to design more engaging and meaningful activities that incorporate visual methods in teaching peace and social responsibility. The results also provide the school administration with insights on how to support programs that foster creativity and social awareness among students. Finally, future researchers may use this study as a reference for exploring visual representations of peace in higher education and other contexts.

1.2 Theoretical Framework

The research will utilize Symbolic Interactionism. George Herbert Mead developed a theory, and Herbert Blumer later organized it into a system. This framework is especially adept at elucidating how individuals ascribe meaning to abstract concepts like peace, articulated symbolically through language, gestures, and visual representations.

Symbolic Interactionism asserts that individuals behave according to the meanings objects and situations hold for them, which are formed through social interactions and continually altered through a process of interpretation (Blumer, 1969). The theory underscores the importance of symbols as fundamental instruments for communication and for constructing meaning construction in social contexts. Utilizing the lens of symbolic interactionism, this study explores

students' visual representation of peace, focusing on how learners conceptualize and communicate the notion of peace through visual media. Every student forms their understanding of peace through individual experiences, cultural contexts, and social interactions. These meanings are subsequently externalized through drawings.

This theoretical framework facilitates a comprehensive examination of the formation, dissemination, and potential transformation of peace meanings. It elucidates how students' representations may embody overarching social values, ideologies, and conflicts, and how these are navigated through symbolic manifestations of peace. Students are not simply portraying peace as a universal or immutable concept. Instead, they are actively creating meaning. This research employs Symbolic Interactionism to elucidate the variations in students' interpretations of peace, the social factors that influence these interpretations, and how visual representations function as communicative acts that both reflect and construct social reality.

1.3 Review of Related Literature

This review of related literature analyzes the varied research that underpins the current study on students' visual representations of peace. The framework integrates domestic and global research on peace education, arts-based pedagogy, youth engagement, and the cultural interpretations of peace.

The most common, immediate understanding of peace is negative peace. This simply refers to the absence of direct, organized violence, such as the cessation of war between states, a ceasefire, or the lack of overt armed conflict within a country. It is a definition of peace based on the *lack* of something harmful (Dlewis, 2025).

The presence of insurgency is a clear and dramatic manifestation of the failure of negative peace. Insurgency is an organized armed resistance against a state's political authority, fundamentally representing a state of ongoing direct violence. While it may not be a large-scale international war, an insurgency signifies that a significant portion of the population is actively engaged in hostility, meaning the society has not achieved even the minimum condition of negative peace. A government might claim peace exists, but if an insurgency is active, that claim is instantly refuted by the continuous, visible disruption of law and order and the persistent use of force.

This is why scholars argue that negative peace alone is insufficient. When direct violence (like an insurgency) is absent, the society may only be experiencing a temporary truce enforced by repression or military might.

This brings us to positive peace. This concept moves beyond mere silence and refers to the presence of the conditions necessary for true, sustained stability. Positive peace is defined by the existence of factors such as social justice, economic equity, political inclusion, and non-discriminatory governance. It focuses on dismantling structural violence—the systemic ways in which social, political, and economic structures harm people and prevent them from meeting their basic needs, which often fuels movements like insurgencies in the first place. Therefore, positive peace views a healthy society as one where everyone has dignity and opportunity (Kumar, 2025).

The concept of social peace is widely understood between negative peace the absence of direct violence and positive peace, which refers to the presence of social justice, inclusivity, and structures that support long-term human development (Galtung, 2021). In conflict-affected

communities, achieving social peace requires not only stopping armed hostilities but also addressing the systemic and structural issues that give rise to conflict. This framework is highly relevant in the Philippine context, where communities previously affected by insurgency require both physical security and social transformation to attain lasting peace.

In the Philippines, the government's peace building framework under the Whole-of-Nation Approach, institutionalized through Executive Order No. 70, integrates these two forms of peace by combining security operations with socio-economic and governance reforms. This national strategy emphasizes convergent efforts among government agencies to address the root causes of armed rebellion and promote community development (Office of the Presidential Adviser on Peace, Reconciliation, and Unity (OPAPRU, 2019). Such policies reflect a shift from purely militaristic solutions toward a more comprehensive model of peacebuilding.

Insurgency in the Philippines has historically been driven by multi-dimensional issues such as poverty, inequity, weak local governance, and limited access to services. The presence of insurgent groups disrupts social order, weakens institutions, and heightens community insecurity conditions indicating a breakdown of negative peace. As a result, restoring negative peace requires both security operations and the reduction of conditions that enable insurgency to thrive. Security forces have employed a combination of community engagement and intelligence operations to dismantle guerrilla fronts.

A study profiling former rebels in 2020 showed that "hearts-and-minds" programs focusing on outreach, dialogue, and social assistance significantly undermined insurgent recruitment and encouraged surrenders (Journal News, 2021). These efforts contribute to

restoring immediate stability, yet scholars emphasize that negative peace alone cannot produce lasting societal harmony. Pathways to Positive Social Peace Beyond the cessation of violence, peace becomes sustainable only when communities experience participation, justice, and development.

Recent empirical evidence from the Revitalized Pulis sa Barangay (R-PSB) program demonstrates how safety and development converge to build positive peace. In barangays previously influenced by insurgency, R-PSB interventions combining community policing, service delivery, and development programs improved public trust in government institutions and strengthened community cohesion (Padua et al., 2023). The study concluded that the presence of responsive institutions reduced residents' vulnerability to insurgent influence and enabled greater community involvement in governance (Padua et al., 2023).

Positive peace is further reinforced by inclusive development efforts. The Mindanao Development Authority (MINDA) reported that since 2020, intensified socio-economic programs in conflict-affected communities such as livelihood support, infrastructure projects, and social protection services contributed to their gradual transition into "insurgency-free" zones (MINDA, 2025). These shows that long-term social peace is built not only through security but also through empowerment and equitable access to opportunities. Reintegration of Former Rebels and Community Healing The reintegration of ex-combatants is a crucial aspect of peace building, as it helps stabilize communities and rebuild social trust. Lao et al. (2024) conducted a study on former rebels in Davao del Sur and found that livelihood programs, psycho social support, and community acceptance were essential in facilitating their successful reintegration. The study emphasized that ex-combatants who received multidimensional support were more likely to reintegrate peacefully

and contribute to local development (Lao et al., 2024). Reintegration therefore represents a bridge between negative and positive peace by ensuring that individuals formerly involved in violence can return as productive members of society. These findings align with the broader understanding that peace is not merely the absence of conflict but the presence of mechanisms that promote healing, reconciliation, and long-term community resilience. Reintegration processes help

The first theme, **Peace Among Children in Visual Representation,** explores how children use drawings and visual imagery to represent their early ideas of peace. Their visual expressions reveal emotional states, social experiences, and perceptions of harmony and conflict within their environments. The Second Theme, **Making Sense of Children's Visual Expressions of Social Peace,** this theme focuses on how researchers interpret the meanings embedded in children's artwork. Colors, symbols, and composition provide insight into how children understand cooperation, fairness, safety, and peaceful relationships in their social world. The Third Theme, **Arts-Based Approaches to Peace Education.** This theme discusses how creative activities such as painting, drawing, storytelling, and performance enhance peace education by fostering emotional expression, empathy, participation, and deeper engagement in peace-learning processes. The Fourth Theme, **Capturing Authentic Child Voices in Meaning-Making Through Audio Narratives,** examines methods that use children's spoken stories and audio-recorded reflections to uncover how they think about social peace. These narratives provide authentic, child-centered perspectives that complement visual forms of expression. The fifth Theme, **Children's Artistic Expression of Social Peace**, this theme highlights how children's artistic creations depict their views of harmony, kindness, and ideal social interactions. Through art-making, children construct and communicate their ideas of positive relationships and peaceful communities. The Sixth

Theme, **Cultural Responsive and Community-Based Perspectives of Peace Education** emphasizes that peace learning must be rooted in cultural identity, community values, and local traditions. It highlights the importance of indigenous perspectives, cultural relevance, and community engagement in shaping meaningful peace education. The Seventh Theme, **Children's Meaning-Making Through Symbols and Material Drawing Practices,** this theme explores how children use symbols, materials, and drawing processes to construct meaning about social peace. Their choices in tools, textures, and symbolic elements reflect cognitive, emotional, and experiential understandings of peaceful living.

Peace in education has become increasingly important, as schools are seen as key places to build a culture of peace (Navarro & Castro, 2020). Research underscores that peace transcends mere absence of conflict, encompassing values such as justice, belonging, and cultural identity (Anderson & Nestrova, 2024).

Peace among Children in Visual Representation

Children often express what peace means to them through drawings, colors, and symbols that reveal both their personal experiences and their understanding of the world around them. According to Gulec (2021), children's artworks reflect not only their awareness of peace but also their exposure to war and conflict. Blasch and Thoma (2024) explain that integrating art-based reflection in peace education helps children think more deeply about what peace represents in their lives. Meanwhile, Deguara (2024) emphasizes that pairing children's drawings with narrative discussions allows educators to explore their perceptions more meaningfully. Cultural background plays a significant role in how children portray peace. Restoy et al. (2022) note that cultural factors must always be considered when interpreting children's artworks. Similarly, Ioannou et al. (2022) argue that children's visual expressions should be analyzed with both emotional and cultural

sensitivity. Vettori et al. (2022) further reveal that children's drawings often mirror their emotional conditions and their sense of safety and security. Combining visual art and open discussion makes interpretations of children's peace imagery more reliable. Fabris et al. (2023) recommend engaging children in reflective conversations to better understand the meanings behind their art. Gulec (2021) also stresses the importance of conducting interviews to clarify the deeper intentions and emotions in children's visual expressions. Children's understanding of peace often begins with simple ideas such as harmony and the absence of war. Reyes and Bautista (2020) find that indigenous students associate peace with their connection to nature, tradition, and community. Nesterova and Anderson (2024) observe that many young people today connect peace with inclusion, equality, and environmental care. Haruna (2022) points out that drawings are a powerful way for displaced children to communicate messages of peace when words fall short. Anderson and Nesterova (2024) conclude that combining art-based practices like drawing, painting, and peace walks helps learners express their unique perceptions of harmony and cooperation.

Making Sense of Children's Visual Expressions of Social Peace

Social peace, defined as harmonious interpersonal relationships, cooperation, empathy, and the presence of social cohesion, has become an important focus of educational research. Children's drawings offer a valuable window into how young learners conceptualize and express social peace, as they provide symbolic and creative means for representing relationships, community, and positive interactions. Recent studies highlight that drawings serve not only as reflective tools but also as instruments for peace education, allowing children to communicate and internalize social values in a developmentally appropriate manner.

Güleç (2021) investigated children's perceptions of peace through drawings and interviews, revealing that children frequently represented peace as interpersonal harmony and relational well-being. Symbols such as hearts, smiling figures, flowers, and peace signs were commonly used to depict friendship, cooperation, and acts of care. Similarly, Deguara (2024) explored how students made meaning of peace and war through drawings, highlighting that even young children could represent complex social and emotional concepts. Children depicted safe, happy, and cooperative spaces, using colors, lines, and symbolic figures to communicate social harmony. Cornaggia et al. (2024) similarly reported that Italian children, when prompted to draw about peace in the context of the Ukraine war, favored bright colors and collaborative scenes, emphasizing relational and communal aspects of peace. These studies indicate that children's visual expressions of peace often center on interpersonal relationships, empathy, and collective well-being.

Art-based interventions have also demonstrated the pedagogical potential of drawing in fostering social peace. Khairuddin, Idrus, Razak, and Ismail (2023) implemented art activities in preschool settings in Malaysia to promote peace education, observing that children's drawings reflected themes of love, unity, cooperation, and social inclusion. Toklu and Amca (2024) similarly found that integrating drawing into early childhood peace education enhanced children's communication, social sensitivity, and peer relationships. These studies confirm that drawing can be an active tool to nurture social peace, as it allows children to process social experiences and internalize relational values. The emotional and socio-cultural dimensions of children's drawings further contribute to understanding social peace. No (2024) examined drawings of children in conflict-affected contexts, highlighting that even in adverse situations, children included elements of social connection, care, and communal safety in their artworks. Mondragón, Idoiaga, and

Capurso (2022) explored children's representations during COVID-19 lockdowns, revealing that drawings conveyed feelings of isolation as well as longing for social contact and cooperative interaction, emphasizing that children's understanding of social peace is linked to emotional security and relational continuity. Additionally, conceptual studies underscore the importance of relational and positive peace as a social process. Blasch (2024) analyzed children's drawings combined with textual descriptions, illustrating that children frame peace in terms of mutual care, collaboration, and inclusion, while Huxley (2025) argued that art-based pedagogies foster dialogical engagement, allowing children to negotiate meaning, empathize with others, and cultivate social cohesion. These findings align with the broader theoretical understanding that social peace is actively constructed through relationships and collaborative practices, rather than merely the absence of conflict.

Taken together, the literature indicates that children's drawings are not only reflective of their internalized ideas of social harmony but also serve as instruments for developing and expressing social peace. Through the use of lines, colors, symbols, and representational figures, children communicate relational understanding, empathy, and cooperative behaviors, which are central to social peace. Drawing emerges as both a research tool and an educational strategy to foster positive social interactions, communal awareness, and interpersonal well-being among children.

Arts-Based Approaches to Peace Education Programs

Arts-based strategies make peace education more participatory, creative, and meaningful. According to Anderson et al. (2024), artistic activities encourage active learning by allowing students to engage both cognitively and emotionally with the concept of peace. Similarly, Breed et al. (2022) explain that collaborative art-making fosters dialogue, trust, and mutual

understanding within communities. Bae-Dimitriadis (2024) emphasizes that integrating the arts into peace education promotes empathy and critical reflection, helping learners to better understand social harmony and conflict resolution. Dunne et al. (2023) further demonstrate that peace-centered pedagogy enhances students' academic performance while also cultivating their social and emotional awareness. Creative innovation also plays a key role in peacebuilding through visual expression. Moller and Bellmer (2023) introduce the concept of Interactive Peace Imagery (IPI), which encourages learners to visualize peace in collaborative and imaginative ways. Hazenberg et al. (2025) assert that the process of creating art together strengthens intergroup relationships, enhances trust, and promotes mutual respect among diverse participants.

In the Philippine context, the Teach Peace Build Peace Movement (2020) highlights that participation in artistic projects helps learners internalize peace values and apply them in daily life. The University of the Philippines (2024) also implements community-based art initiatives that promote awareness of justice, human rights, and social responsibility. Likewise, Breed et al. (2022) point out that co-created, art-based research fosters dialogue, emotional healing, and reconciliation in communities affected by conflict. At the classroom level, Bae-Dimitriadis (2024) proposes practical strategies for integrating the creative arts into peace education, while Jolyon (2020) emphasizes that artistic expression can serve as a tool for resolving interpersonal conflicts and nurturing understanding. Anderson et al. (2024) argue that creative approaches empower young people to become active peacebuilders through collaboration, reflection, and imagination. Similarly, Dunne et al. (2024) recommend the use of arts-based workshops that cultivate empathy, civic responsibility, and social participation. The Aesthetics of Peace Project (2024) underscores that creativity not only inspires individual reflection but also drives collective action toward peace.

Paat et al. (2025) add that such initiatives contribute to civic learning, moral development,

and violence prevention. On a broader scale, art has been proven to support emotional healing and trauma recovery. Nadam (2023) reports that art therapy promotes psychological recovery among refugees and war-affected individuals. Onuorah (2022) observes that art workshops in Nigeria enhance peace awareness among youth, fostering a culture of dialogue and tolerance.

Holochwost et al. (2021) demonstrate that participation in artistic activities improves socio-emotional competence and empathy among students, while Khairuddin (2023) notes that Malaysian learners develop values of cooperation, patience, and mutual respect through sustained artistic engagement.

Capturing Authentic Child Voices in Meaning-Making About Social Peace Through Audio--Recorded Narratives

Audio recording children's verbal explanations preserve the verbatim speech and thus reduces loss or distortion that occurs when researchers rely only on memory or hurried field notes (McMullin, 2021). Recordings enable researchers to re-listen a step that improves analytic depth because repeated listening reveals nuances and supports more careful coding decisions (Hill, 2022). Audio captures paralinguistic information (tone, pitch, pauses, laughter, speed) that often carries emotional meaning does not present in transcripts alone and that can change interpretation of what a child says about a drawing (Guyer et al., 2021). Multi-modal approaches that triangulate transcript, audio, and (when available) video data produce richer analysis because the aural channel adds layers of meaning beyond words on a page (Craig, McInroy, Goulden, & Eaton, 2021).

Narrative inquiry has become a valuable qualitative method for exploring students' personal experiences, beliefs, and values. This approach is especially useful when studying concepts like peace, which cannot be fully measured through surveys alone. As Rahmawati (2022)

demonstrated in her narrative study with language learners, audio-recorded interviews allow participants to express their inner thoughts freely, making their stories more detailed and emotionally authentic. Recorded narratives preserve tone, pauses, emphasis, and emotion—elements that help researchers understand how students genuinely experience and interpret peace in their everyday lives. Several researchers have emphasized the importance of using narratives to explore peace-related experiences among youth. For instance, Bajaj and Hantzopoulos (2020) highlight that peace education is most effective when students share their own stories of conflict, cooperation, and reconciliation. Through recorded conversations, students describe how they define peace, how they deal with disagreements, and how their environment influences their sense of safety and harmony.

These narratives help researchers recognize patterns in students' behavior and understand the social conditions that shape their attitudes toward peace. Similarly, McGlynn et al. (2022) used narrative interviews to explore how students from conflict-affected communities perceive peacebuilding in schools. They found that students' recorded stories revealed not only their hopes for peaceful relationships but also the hidden fears, tensions, and biases that are not usually visible in quantitative studies. Audio recordings captured emotions and hesitations that signaled deeper feelings, making the data richer and more meaningful. This supports Rahmawati's argument that recorded narratives provide depth that written responses cannot offer. According to Martínez-Mesa et al., 2020, when teachers choose participants based on convenience, perceived compliance, or academic performance, students with alternative experiences—such as those who have witnessed or experienced conflicts—may be excluded. This selective participation can skew the findings and fail to reflect the full spectrum of student perspectives on peace.

Comparative research shows that interviews conducted without recorders can sometimes produce usable data, but recording remains the best practice for preserving detail and for enabling later checks of accuracy and interpretation (Rutakumwa et al., 2020). Long-form and naturalistic audio research literature highlights both the value of high-fidelity audio for accessing subtle social behavior and the ethical responsibilities to manage consent, privacy, and data security carefully (Cychosz et al., 2020). Methodological reviews emphasize that transcription is not a neutral conversion; transcript decisions (e.g., intelligent vs. full verbatim) shape analysis, so keeping original audio allows researchers to check transcription choices and preserve analytic transparency (McMullin, 2021). Guidance on research with children recommends explicit, child-appropriate information about recording and where appropriate using audio as a consent/assent option when literacy or language barriers exist (Horowicz, 2023). Team or double-checking procedures (e.g., having a second researcher compare transcript to audio) increase dependability by reducing single-researcher bias in transcription and interpretation (Hill, 2022). Finally, recording and retaining audio files creates an audit trail that strengthens trustworthiness and allows reviewers or co-researchers to verify interpretation decisions during peer review or supervision (McMullin, 2021; Cychosz et al., 2020).

Children's Artistic Expression of Social Peace in Conflict-Affected Rural Areas

Students living in rural or conflict-affected areas are often exposed to violence, displacement, and social instability, which can affect their emotional, social, and cognitive development. Drawing and other creative arts have been identified as effective tools for children to express experiences, process trauma, and communicate their understanding of social peace.

Children's Drawings as Windows into Conflict Experiences Children in conflict zones use drawing to convey both traumatic experiences and social relationships. IDP children and non-

displaced peers in Myanmar depicted relational aspects of their lives through symbols and figures, highlighting desires for social cohesion (Lokola, 2024). Art as a Therapeutic and Meaning-Making Tool Creative arts interventions support children's well-being and provide a platform for expressing social and emotional concerns (Buser, 2024). Art therapy with refugee children has been shown to foster empathy, social understanding, and resilience (Ramadan, 2024). Mask-making and projective drawing techniques allow children to communicate relational perspectives in conflict-affected settings (Green, 2019).

Expressing Social Peace and Relational Values even in conflict contexts, children often depict cooperation, friendship, and communal harmony through drawings (Denov, 2024). Children indirectly affected by conflict use drawings to represent safe and cooperative spaces, often employing bright colors and symbolic figures to express social harmony (Deguara, 2024).

Participatory arts programs further enable children to actively contribute to peacebuilding, developing relational skills through collaborative creation (Paterson-Young, 2024). Children's Drawings as Indicators of Emotional and Social Resilience Drawings provide insight into children's socio-emotional functioning. Arts-based interventions in humanitarian settings strengthen psychosocial resilience while promoting social understanding (Frasco et al., 2025). Drawings by former child soldiers reflect trauma as well as hope and relational repair (Ahmad, 2024). The Bridge Drawing Test with refugee minors reveals how children express relational security and aspirations for community connection (Girsh, 2024). Contextual Evidence from Rural and Conflict-Affected Areas Field-based studies from the Philippines and Cameroon show that children in rural conflict zones use drawing to depict both traumatic experiences and visions of social harmony (Gutang, 2024).

Children exposed to armed conflict or displacement employ drawing to communicate social and emotional realities (Denov, 2024). Creative arts in conflict zones facilitate dialogue, social cohesion, and children's sense of belonging (Davis, 2021). Participatory and Community-Oriented Approaches, children become agents of social peace when they collaboratively create artwork, negotiate meaning, and develop empathy (Breed et al., 2024). Arts-based interventions in conflict-affected communities foster dialogue, promote social cohesion, and strengthen relational skills (Paterson-Young, 2024). Systematic reviews show that art therapy effectively supports psychosocial well-being in conflict-affected and displaced children (Anous, Al-Hroub, & El Zein, 2022). Drawing and arts-based approaches also allow children to articulate aspirations for social harmony despite adverse contexts (Ahmad, 2024). Overall, the literature demonstrates that children's drawings in rural or conflict-affected areas reflect social relationships, community, and relational peace. Art provides both a reflective and therapeutic tool, allowing children to represent trauma, resilience, and hope. Participatory arts-based approaches empower children to contribute to social peace, empathy, and cooperation, justifying the use of drawings as a research method to study social peace in conflict-affected rural contexts (Deguara, 2024).

Policy and Institutional Frameworks of Peace Education

Institutional policies form the backbone of sustainable peace education. The Department of Education (2020) has declared schools as "zones of peace," embedding peacebuilding in educational policy. Despite this, Purwanto et al. (2023) note that arts-based learning remains limited in classroom practice. The Department of Education (2022) includes peace values in the national curriculum, but Purwanto et al. (2023) observes inconsistencies in implementation across universities. Floresta (2022) explains that the national framework integrates peace values throughout the education system. Macabato (2023) recommends adopting culturally responsive

teaching strategies to make peace education more inclusive. The Commission on Higher Education (2024) also provides guidelines for embedding peace education in tertiary programs. Sapao and Dacles (2023) note that even with limited resources, teachers creatively use visual materials like posters and short films to promote peace in classrooms.

These policies align with the Philippine Development Plan (2020), which recognizes peace and justice as national goals. However, Mabunga (2016) stresses that challenges remain, including inconsistent implementation and lack of institutional support. Continuous evaluation and stronger partnerships between educators and policymakers are needed to fully integrate peace education nationwide.

Recent empirical and conceptual research underscores the increasing institutionalization of peace education at multiple levels. Khan (2019) shows how secondary-school curricula and teacher practices begin to integrate peace education, pointing to both opportunities and challenges for institutional adoption. Institutional frameworks are further elaborated at the teacher-education level: Mabunga's (2022) study on UNESCO-ASPnet member TEIs demonstrates that administrators, faculty, and students view peace education positively, offering a workable framework for teacher training institutions. At the school-division level, Sapao & Dacles (2021) document how peace-education policies translate into what they term a "peace culture," suggesting institutionalization beyond mere curricular insertion. In post-conflict contexts, local governance matters: Zainal et al. (2021) reveal that, even where local governments attempt to embed peace education in secondary schools, normative and sociological challenges (e.g., religious or national curricula priorities) may limit effective implementation. In higher education, Millican et al. (2021) argue passionately for embedding peace building pedagogies at HEIs, illustrating how institutional structures, curricula, and teacher training converge. National-level

policy frameworks are also under critical evaluation: Tumamin et al. (2024) examine how a formal "Schools as Zones of Peace" policy plays out in Philippine secondary schools, revealing gaps in governance and outcomes. Broader structural critiques such as Akar (2024) show that institutional failures, political gridlock, and governance deficits often hamper the potential of education to contribute to sustainable peace in conflict-affected nations. Finally, bibliometric evidence (Istianah et al., 2024) confirms an upward trend in peace-education scholarship globally, reflecting growing institutional and academic commitment.

Cultural Responsive and Community-Based Perspectives on Peace Education

Peace education must reflect the cultural, social, and environmental realities of each community. Olivilius and Akebo (2021) assert that programs are most effective when adapted to local traditions and values. Lokola (2024) adds that marginalized groups are often excluded from peace efforts, calling for more inclusive and equitable frameworks. Delos Reyes and Santos (2023) demonstrate that contextualized art practices, such as using indigenous symbols, can promote cultural understanding and social harmony. Nguyen et al. (2020) highlights that visual methodologies like drawing and photography foster emotional and cognitive engagement with peace concepts. Galtung (2021) expands the idea of peace by defining it as both social and environmental equity. Millican et al. (2021) stress the role of higher education in cultivating civic responsibility and peace-oriented values. Smieszek (2022) links peace education with climate justice, while Castle (2025) describes peace as an active, participatory process that requires ongoing dialogue and cooperation. Glowacki (2022) warns that peace initiatives can unintentionally create tension if underlying inequalities are ignored.

Paterson (2024) finds that local mediation efforts reduce community violence and strengthen cooperation. The Philippine Framework of Peace (2023) provides a foundation for

understanding peace within local contexts. Savelyeva and Park (2024) argue that environmental education fosters both personal and collective peace, while O'Connor and Hearn (2023) show that visual arts empower youth to express their roles as peacebuilders. Bellmer and Moller (2023) identify images as neutral spaces for intercultural dialogue, and Restoy et al. (2022) highlight the influence of culture on how children visually represent peace.

St Andrews Project (2023) shows that involving students in participatory art projects increases their engagement and sense of inclusion. Castle (2025) explains that peace begins in the home and community through empathy, cooperation, and respect. Mendoza and Flor (2021) observe that participatory visual activities such as drawing, and photography allow young people to express peace imaginatively. Mabunga (2016) finds that local peacebuilding initiatives help strengthen communities and prevent violence. Holochwost et al. (2021) note that children's drawings reveal their emotions and understanding of peace, making them valuable tools for educators. Langhout et al. (2021) show that digital photovoice projects empower youth to share their visions of peace and collective action online. Finally, Comics as Peace Pedagogy for Children (2023) concludes that comics effectively teach empathy, cooperation, and respect through visual storytelling.

Children's Meaning-Making Through Symbolic and Material Drawing Practices

Children's drawings have been widely examined in educational and psychological research as meaningful tools through which young learners interpret and communicate complex social concepts such as war, peace, conflict, and interpersonal relationships. Recent scholarships emphasize that children's meaning-making is shaped not only by what they draw, but also by the materials, symbols, and processes involved in their drawing activities. One important dimension of this process is the drawing surface provided to children.

Children's drawings are widely recognized as powerful semiotic tools through which young people communicate internal states, social understandings, and experiences that may be difficult to articulate verbally. Yu and Nagai (2020) demonstrate that children's use of visual elements such as line quality, color choices, shapes, and compositional balance mirrors their psychological development and evolving self-perception. This indicates that the visual decisions children make are meaningful, not random. Research in adverse contexts reinforces this interpretive value. Goldner, Lev-Wiesel, and Binson (2021) found that children who experienced abuse frequently embedded symbolic cues in their drawings, including dark shapes, distorted figures, or protective barriers, which reflected fear, relational stress, or attempts to assert safety. Similarly, cultural-semiotic analysis by Kelly and Green (2024) shows that children construct meaning through their visual grammar; they use spatial arrangement, emphasis, and symbolic elements to express what they consider significant within their social worlds. These findings highlight drawing as a meaning-making practice shaped by cultural and interpersonal experience. Studies linking drawing to resilience further deepen this understanding. A 2023 participatory visual study from the University of Chester found that adolescents used recurring visual motifs such as connected figures, shields, or elevated characters to represent strength, supportive relationships, and emotional endurance.

Beyond the drawings themselves, narrative explanation enhances interpretive clarity. A study published in Frontiers in Education (2025) demonstrated that when children narrate their drawings, they align visual design elements (lines, spatial emphasis, and character placement) with story structure and emotional themes, indicating that drawing is a multimodal meaning-making practice. Additional evidence indicates that children's visual choices also reflect broader developmental and identity processes, as seen in an MDPI study (2022) analyzing children's

paintings transformed into public artworks; the authors observed that composition and color patterns corresponded with self-concept, emotional tone, and environmental influences.

Deguara (2024) found that plain drawing paper remains a preferred and effective medium for eliciting children's expressions of war and peace. Its flexibility allows children to freely create lines, symbols, and color variations, enabling them to externalize their ideas without structural constraints. The simplicity of paper supports nuanced expression, making it an accessible platform for children to articulate complex emotional and conceptual understandings. The tools children use also influence their expressive capacities. According to Güleç (2021), children commonly employ basic art materials such as crayons and colored pencils when representing themes related to peace. These easily accessible tools facilitate the creation of recognizable icons of hearts, flowers, and peace signs that serve as symbolic representations of children's social, emotional, and moral perspectives.

Such symbolic forms allow children to communicate abstract concepts through familiar imagery. Minimalist drawing tools, particularly pencils, have also been identified as significant within research contexts. The article Drawing as a Space for Social-Cognitive Interaction (Education Sciences, 2022) argues that simple line drawing reduces emphasis on artistic skill and instead foregrounds children's cognitive and social processes. Through line work, children engage in shared thinking, negotiation of ideas, and reflection on social experiences. Thus, the drawing process itself becomes a space for social-cognitive interaction rather than merely a production of visual artifacts. Color is another central component of meaning-making in children's artwork. A study published in Ricerche di Psicologia (2025) reports that children typically use brighter, more varied colors when drawing themes related to peace, while depictions of war tend to contain darker or muted tones. This contrast reflects an emotional and symbolic distinction: warm,

colorful palettes are associated with hope, harmony, and positivity, whereas subdued colors evoke conflict, fear, or tension. Color therefore operates as an emotional language through which children differentiate experiences and perspectives related to peace and war. Finally, research underscores the symbolic significance of lines, shapes, and imagery in children's depictions of conflict and harmony.

Deguara (2024) notes that children employ diverse representational tools—such as depictions of weapons, protective figures, or natural environments to convey their understandings of conflict, safety, and peace. These visual elements function as symbolic devices that reveal children's internal representations and emotional responses to social issues. The combination of lines, colors, and shapes creates a visual narrative that expresses both the intensity and complexity of children's concepts of war and peace.

1.4 Schematic Diagram

This schematic diagram shows the flow of the study on students' visual representation of peace. The study begins with students creating drawings to express their understanding of peace, which serve as the main visual representation. These drawings are then analyzed by interpreting the symbols and elements used by the students based on their explanations. From this process, common ideas and meanings are identified and developed into thematic insights. Lastly, these themes become the basis for making actionable recommendations that may help improve peace education and related practices.

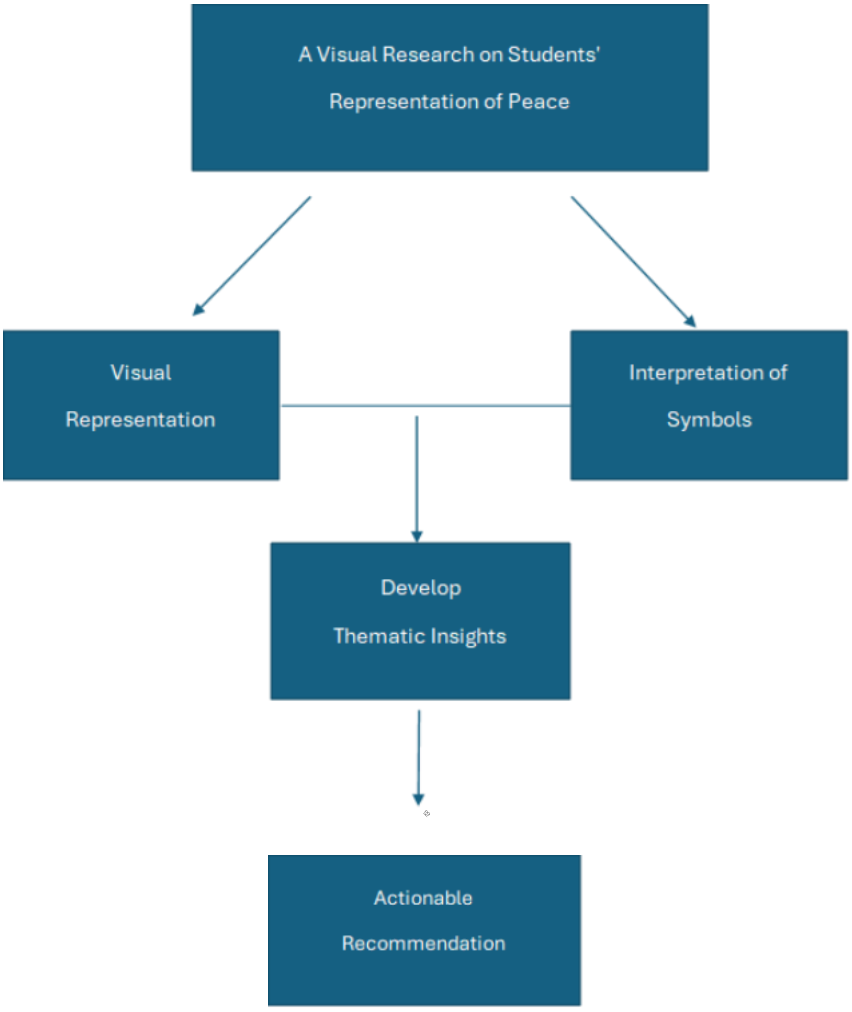


Figure 1: Schematic Diagram of the Study on Students' Visual Representation of Peace

1.5 Objectives of the Study

This study aims to explore how students conceptualize and express the ideas of peace through visual art. Specifically, it seeks to:

1. Analyze the students' interpretation of their visual representation of peace;

2. Interpret the symbolism and meanings embedded in students' visuals;

3. Develop thematic insights from students' narratives to explain their visual representation; and

4. Provide actionable recommendations to strengthen peace education programs within the institution.

1.6 Definition of Terms

To ensure conceptual precision and clarity, in the use of terms, which are operationally defined for this study, the following terms were used:

1. **Arts-Based Approaches to Peace Education.** This refers to the use of visual art activities such as drawing and sketching in this study to allow second-year criminology students to express their understanding and views of peace.
2. **Audio-Recorded Student Narratives.** This refers to the verbal explanations and reflections shared by second-year criminology students about their visual artworks, which were captured through audio recordings during data gathering.
3. **Culturally Responsive and Community-Based Peace Education.** This refers to peace-related ideas reflected in the visual outputs of second-year criminology students that are influenced by their cultural background, community values, and lived social experiences.
4. **Meaning-Making Through Symbols and Drawing Practices.** This refers to how second-year criminology students use symbols, colors, and images in their drawings to communicate and interpret their personal meanings of peace.
5. **Peace in Visual Representation.** This refers to the drawings and visual artworks created by second-year criminology students that illustrate their understanding and perception of peace.

6. **Students' Artistic Expression of Social Peace.** This refers to the artworks produced by second-year criminology students that depict ideas such as justice, cooperation, respect, and peaceful social relationships.

7. **Students' Visual Expressions of Social Peace.** This refers to the messages and meanings conveyed in the visual outputs of second-year criminology students that represent harmony, fairness, and positive social interaction.

CHAPTER 2

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

This chapter presents the research design, locale, respondents, research instruments, ethical standards, data gathering procedure, and data analysis plan. These components collectively describe the systematic process that guided the conduct of the study.

2.1 Research Design

This study uses a qualitative visual research design to understand how students see and express the idea of peace. This approach is based on the Interactive Peace Imagery (IPI) framework of Möller and Bellmer (2023), which views peace as an experience that can be shown and shared through images. The IPI framework encourages students to create drawings that reflect their thoughts, feelings, and understanding of peace. Through this method, students' artwork becomes more than pictures; it tells a story about how they personally experience and imagine peace.

Students' drawings are treated as the main source of information, while their explanations of the images provide additional insight. This allows the study to capture not only the symbols and creative choices in their work but also the personal meaning behind them. By combining visual expression with students' own reflections, the study can reveal the unique ways they interpret and communicate peace, which words alone might not fully express.

The research design is directly guided by the IPI framework, shaping how data is collected and analyzed. It emphasizes participation, creativity, and reflection, allowing students to actively share their perspectives. Through this approach, the study uncovers the emotional, symbolic, and personal aspects of peace as experienced by the students, providing a deeper understanding of how peace is imagined, represented, and shared in their everyday lives.

2.2 Research Materials and Methods

The materials for this research are based on the IPI (Interactive Peace Imagery) framework established by Moller and Bellmer (2023). The research is structured into two distinct components: physical instrumentation and procedural execution. The primary instrument for data collection is the IPI Protocol, which consists of two specialized components:

● **The Visual Expression (artwork):** Participants are provided with standardized drawing materials. These materials are intentionally selected to allow for a full range of symbolic representation, enabling students to externalize abstract peace concepts into visual form without the constraints of a specific artistic style.

● **The Guided Reflection Instrument:** This is a structured narrative prompt designed to facilitate the "interactive" component of the IPI framework. It consists of open-ended questions that prompt students to decode their own symbols. These prompts are specifically tailored for Criminology students, focusing on the intersection of peace, social order, and their future professional responsibilities.

The study follows a systematic, two-phase method to ensure the depth and authenticity of the data:

● **Phase I: Visual Production (Interactive Imagery):** In a controlled and contemplative environment, participants are asked to engage in the creative process of "world-making" by drawing their conceptualization of peace. This phase is not timed, allowing for a reflective and non-pressured translation of internal perceptions into external symbols.

● **Phase II: Narrative Elucidation (Guided Reflection):** Immediately following the drawing phase, participants complete the reflection instrument. During this phase, they articulate the personal and academic meanings behind their visual choices. The method focuses on the narrative emerging from the explanation, where the participant acts as the primary interpreter of their work. This ensures that the researchers analyze the student's intended meaning rather than applying an external aesthetic critique.

The research participants are second-year criminology students enrolled in The Contemporary World course. They were chosen because the course includes topics related to peace and social issues, which are connected to the purpose of the study. The recommendations for the participants will be through baseline. We will select students who are willing to participate voluntarily and who can draw through the result of the baseline. To ensure balance, the group will include at least five (5) female and five (5) male students.

The data collection will be conducted through a series of structured yet participatory activities. Before these activities commence, the researchers will obtain permission from the school and the department, as well as consent from all participants. The data will be gathered via a classroom drawing activity based on the Interactive Peace Imagery framework (Moller & Bellmer, 2023). The selected 2nd year criminology students will present drawings illustrating their conceptualization of peace, which is then followed by a short period of verbal reflection and discussion on their artwork. The researchers will collect the drawings and accompanying reflections for subsequent qualitative analysis, while safeguarding the participant's confidentiality, and ensuring ethical data utilization throughout the process.

2.3 Research Environment, Population and Sample

Research Environment

This study was conducted at a private higher education institution in Nasipit, Agusan del Norte, managed by the Roman Catholic Diocese of Butuan. The school offers education from elementary to tertiary levels and has two campuses: the main campus, which includes the College of Criminal Justice Education (CCJE), and a second campus for elementary and senior high school students. The CCJE trains students in Criminology, preparing them for careers in law enforcement and public safety. Peace education is integrated into the general education course at Contemporary World, allowing students to engage with peace-related concepts even if their main program focuses on professional training. The drawing and reflection activities will be conducted in the library discussion room, providing a quiet and controlled environment for focused work.

The college also encourages students to participate in outreach programs and immersion activities in local rural communities such as Simbalan and Hinandayan, which have experienced local conflicts. These experiences give students real-life perspectives on peace and social order. Together with the school's promotion of values like social responsibility, ethics, and community harmony, these factors make the CCJE an ideal environment to explore how students understand, imagine, and express peace in both personal and professional contexts.

Research Participants

The participants in this study are second-year criminology students. They were chosen because their academic training equips them with foundational knowledge in public safety, peace, and order. Criminology education in the Philippines is designed to produce professionals who contribute directly to national security and peacebuilding. The Philippine Criminology Profession

Act of 2018 (RA 11131) formally recognizes criminologists as key actors in maintaining social order. Additionally, partnerships between higher education institutions and law enforcement agencies, guided by CHED Memorandum Order No. 5, series of 2018, provide structured internships and immersion programs, allowing students to apply theoretical peace education in real-life policing and community engagement.

The study focused on students enrolled in General Education Course – The Contemporary World, which integrates peace education. Participants were selected from rural barangays, namely Simbalan and Hinandayan, which have experienced local conflicts. Their experiences in these communities provide real-life perspectives on peace and social order. By combining academic learning with lived experiences, the study captures how students perceive, imagine, and express peace through both their artwork and narratives.

To ensure ethical integrity, specific inclusion, exclusion, and withdrawal criteria were applied. Students who have never resided in the identified barangays or are not enrolled in GEC 5 were excluded. Any participant experiencing severe emotional or psychological distress, as assessed by qualified guidance personnel, was immediately withdrawn to ensure safety. These measures ensure that participation is voluntary, safe, and meaningful. Overall, these participants provide insights showing that peace is not just the absence of conflict, but also involves justice, relationships, and values practiced in schools.

Research Sampling

The researchers will use purposive sampling, the selecting participants based on specific criteria relevant to the study's objectives. The participants will consist of criminology students who are currently enrolled in the General Education Course. Additionally, students from rural barangays (Simbalan and Hinandayan) selected through purposive sampling. This sample is

justified because BSCRIM students have academic training in conflict management, community safety, and restorative justice, which equips them to meaningfully engage in visual and narrative exercises about social peace. Under Republic Act 11131 The Philippine Criminology Profession Act, criminologists are recognized as critical actors in "national security, public safety, and nation building and development. Furthermore, students from these rural communities provide authentic perspectives based on lived experiences of local social tensions and community dynamics.

Inclusion Criteria: Participants are BSCRIM students, residing in the identified barangays, and willing to participate in the drawing and audio-recorded narrative activities.

Exclusion Criteria: Students who have never lived in these barangays are unwilling or unable to participate.

2.4 Research Data and Analysis Plan

Research Instrument

The primary research instrument of this study is a qualitative visual research tool following the Interactive Peace Imagery (IPI) framework developed by Moller and Bellmer (2023). This instrument is designed to gather both visual and narrative data from participants, allowing them to express their understanding of peace through creative and reflective processes.

The research instrument for this study consists of two main components designed to explore the visual representation of peace among second-year criminology students. The first component is a drawing activity, where participants are invited to visually express their understanding, experiences, and perceptions of social peace, conflict, and community

interactions. Students are provided with basic art materials, including paper, pencils, and coloring tools, and are encouraged to create freely without strict artistic rules or limitations. This approach allows them to communicate personal meanings, emotions, and ideas that may be difficult to express verbally. The second component is a guided reflection, consisting of structured, research-made questions used during Focus Group Discussions. These questions help participants reflect on the meaning behind their drawings, explain their artistic choices, and discuss their thoughts on peace, cooperation, and social relationships. Together, these two components complement each other by combining visual expression with verbal reflection, providing a richer understanding of how students conceptualize and experience peace.

Data Analysis

This study will utilize a qualitative visual research design, specifically employing Reflexive Thematic Analysis (RTA) as articulated by Braun and Clarke (2006). This method helps examine how students visually and narratively convey their comprehension of peace, enabling researchers to discern, interpret, and reflect recurring patterns of meaning within the data.

The analysis will consist of six stages of Reflexive Thematic Analysis:

1. **Familiarization with the Data:** The researchers will thoroughly examine the students' artworks and narratives multiple times to fully comprehend their viewpoints on peace.

2. **Generating Initial Codes:** Important visual elements, symbols, colors, and words from the stories will be identified and systematically coded to capture key aspects of the data.

3. **Searching for Themes:** The researchers will group codes into possible themes that show how participants share meanings and ideas.

4. **Reviewing Themes:** The first themes will be refined and checked to ensure they accurately reflect the data and participants' visual and verbal expressions.

5. **Defining and Naming Themes:** Each derived theme will be clearly defined and concisely named to convey its primary meaning and its direct relevance to the study's goals. This process is particularly crucial for elucidating how criminology students conceptualize and articulate the notion of peace.

6. **Writing the Report:** The last step will be to put the themes together into a clear story, using examples from art and participants' thoughts to support it. The report will connect the results to other peace education research and information about the situation.

Interview Guide

The interview guide was prepared to help the researchers gather clear and meaningful answers from the participants regarding their understanding of peace. It served as a simple guide to ensure that all important topics related to the study were discussed during the interview. The questions were open-ended to allow the participants to freely express their thoughts, ideas, and personal experiences without any pressure.

The interview focused on four main questions. First, the participants were asked how they define peace in their own terms to understand their personal views and meanings of peace. Second, they were asked to explain how peace is shown in their drawing in order to connect their verbal explanations with their visual representations. Third, the participants were asked how peace can be maintained based on their own understanding and experiences. Lastly, they were asked for their ideas on how peace education can be improved to help students better understand and practice peace.

These interview questions helped the researchers gain deeper insights into the participants' perceptions of peace and supported the analysis of the drawings and narratives collected in the study.

2.5 Research Ethical Standards

This study will adhere to ethical standards throughout the research process. Before the study begins, formal permission will be requested from the School President of Saint Michael College of Caraga, the Dean of the College, and the Program Head of the Criminology Department. In addition, permission will be obtained from the campus Guidance Center to ensure psychological support if needed. Consent will also be secured from all participating students, and their participation will be completely voluntary.

A. The Intellectual Property Rights (IPR)

The researchers will ensure that all ideas, images, and written work created by participants are appropriately credited. To protect intellectual property rights, any secondary sources, such as literature and frameworks, will be cited in accordance with APA style.

B. Informed Consent

Participants will be fully informed about the purpose of the study, the drawing activity, the audio recording of their explanations, and how their data will be used, their right to withdraw. A written informed consent form will be provided and explained before participation. Students under 18 (if any) will require both parental assent and participant consent. Only those who voluntarily sign the consent form will be allowed to join.

C. Data Privacy, Confidentiality, and Disposal

In strict adherence to the Data Privacy Act of 2012 (RA 10173) and international ethical guidelines, the researchers will implement comprehensive measures to safeguard the anonymity and personal information of all participants. All primary data—including physical drawings, digital transcripts, and audio recordings—will be stored in encrypted, password-protected digital repositories accessible exclusively to the principal research team. To ensure total anonymity, a system of alphanumeric coding or pseudonyms will be utilized during the transcription and analysis phases, ensuring that no personally identifiable information (PII) is linked to the published findings or final reports.

The management of data concludes with a systematic data disposal protocol designed to prevent any unauthorized recovery of sensitive information. Audio recordings, having served their purpose for verbatim transcription and cross-verification, will be permanently deleted from all storage devices immediately upon the completion of the validation phase.

D. Voluntary Participation and Freedom to Withdraw

Participation is fully voluntary. Students may refuse to answer any question, pause the activity, or withdraw from the study at any time without penalty or academic consequence. Their academic standing and relationship with instructors will not be affected by their decision. Students will be given refreshments during the conduct of the FGD and the drawing session.

E. Minimization of Harm

Topics about peace and conflict may cause emotional discomfort, especially for students from rural communities like Simbalan and Hinandayan, who have experienced local conflicts. To reduce any potential harm, the study includes strict protective measures. A licensed guidance counselor from the campus Guidance Center will be available during data collection for emotional support, and the school clinic can also be contacted if additional care is needed, such as treating minor wounds or providing further medical attention. Participants will be reminded that they can withdraw from the study at any time if they feel uneasy. After each session, a structured debriefing will be conducted, and any student showing emotional or physical distress will be referred for follow-up counseling or medical care. These steps ensure that participants are safe, supported, and cared for throughout the research process

F. Beneficence and Contribution to Knowledge

Participation in this study offers direct and indirect benefits to the students. Directly, the drawing and narrative activities provide an opportunity for self-reflection, emotional expression, and personal insight into concepts of social peace and conflict resolution. These findings can inform future peace-building programs, curriculum design, and arts-based interventions in criminology and related disciplines. By linking participants' lived experiences with scholarly analysis, the research adds value to both theory and practice, highlighting the role of students as active contributors to understanding and fostering social peace.

G. Justice and Fair Participation

Participant selection follows the principle of fairness, ensuring that individuals are included based on the study's objectives and not due to vulnerability or convenience. The sample included in the study (BSCRIM students) from rural sitios (Simbalan and Hinandayan) are chosen because their experiences with armed conflict provide relevant perspectives not because they are disadvantaged. All participants will be treated equitably and respectfully.

H. Data Integrity Accuracy

The researchers will transcribe narratives accurately, interpret drawings systematically using established visual analysis frameworks, and avoid altering or omitting information to fit expectations. All findings whether supporting or contradicting assumptions will be reported truthfully. Any limitations or challenges encountered in the research process will also be disclosed.

I. Transparency and Honesty in Reporting

The researchers commit to reporting all procedures, findings, limitations, and challenges honestly and clearly. No data will be fabricated, altered, or misrepresented. Interpretations of drawings and narratives will be based solely on systematic analysis using established frameworks, not personal opinions. Any changes or revisions in the research process will be documented transparently. AI tools may be used only for grammar checking or organizing references, and they will not affect the analysis or interpretation of participants' data. The researchers declare that there are no conflicts of interest that could influence the study's findings.

J. Use of Patented or Copyrighted Materials

The study will not copy or reproduce copyrighted images, artworks, or proprietary materials without permission. When models, frameworks, or visual analysis tools are borrowed from published authors, proper citation and acknowledgment will be provided. All images used in the study will come solely from participants and will not involve copyrighted artwork.

K. Ethical Considerations for Animal and Human Trials

The study follows ethical guidelines for human research: no deception will be used, risks are minimal, and participants' dignity and autonomy are prioritized. Data collection involves only low-risk activities such as drawing and storytelling, with mental health protection measures in place.

CHAPTER 3

RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

3.1 Presentation and Analysis of Data

3.2 Proposed Intervention/ Output

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CHAPTER 4

SUMMARY, CONCLUSION, RECOMMENDATION,

4.1. Summary

4.2. Conclusion

4.3.Recommendation

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CURRICULUM VITAE

Recent ID picture (size 1 ½ x 2, preferably colored)

NAME: Ardel Mae Patunob
ADDRESS: Barangay 7, J.P Rizal St., Nasipit Agusan del Norte,8602
EMAIL:

Personal Information

Sex : Female
Date of birth : September 13, 2004
Height : 5'6
Weight : 53
Civil Status : Single

Educational Attainment

Elementary : Nasipit Central Elementary School
S.Y. 2016-2017
Secondary : Saint Michael College of Caraga
S.Y. 2017-2019
Saint Michael College of Caraga
Humanities and Social Sciences
S.Y. 2020-2023
Tertiary : Saint Michael College of Caraga
Bachelor of Secondary Education Major in Social Studies
S.Y. 2023-present

Membership/Affiliations

ORGANIZATION	POSITIONS HELD

CURRICULUM VITAE

Recent ID picture (size 1 ½ x 2, preferably colored)

NAME:
ADDRESS:
EMAIL:
Personal Information

Sex :
Date of birth :
Height :
Weight :
Civil Status :

Educational Attainment

Elementary :
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Educational Attainment

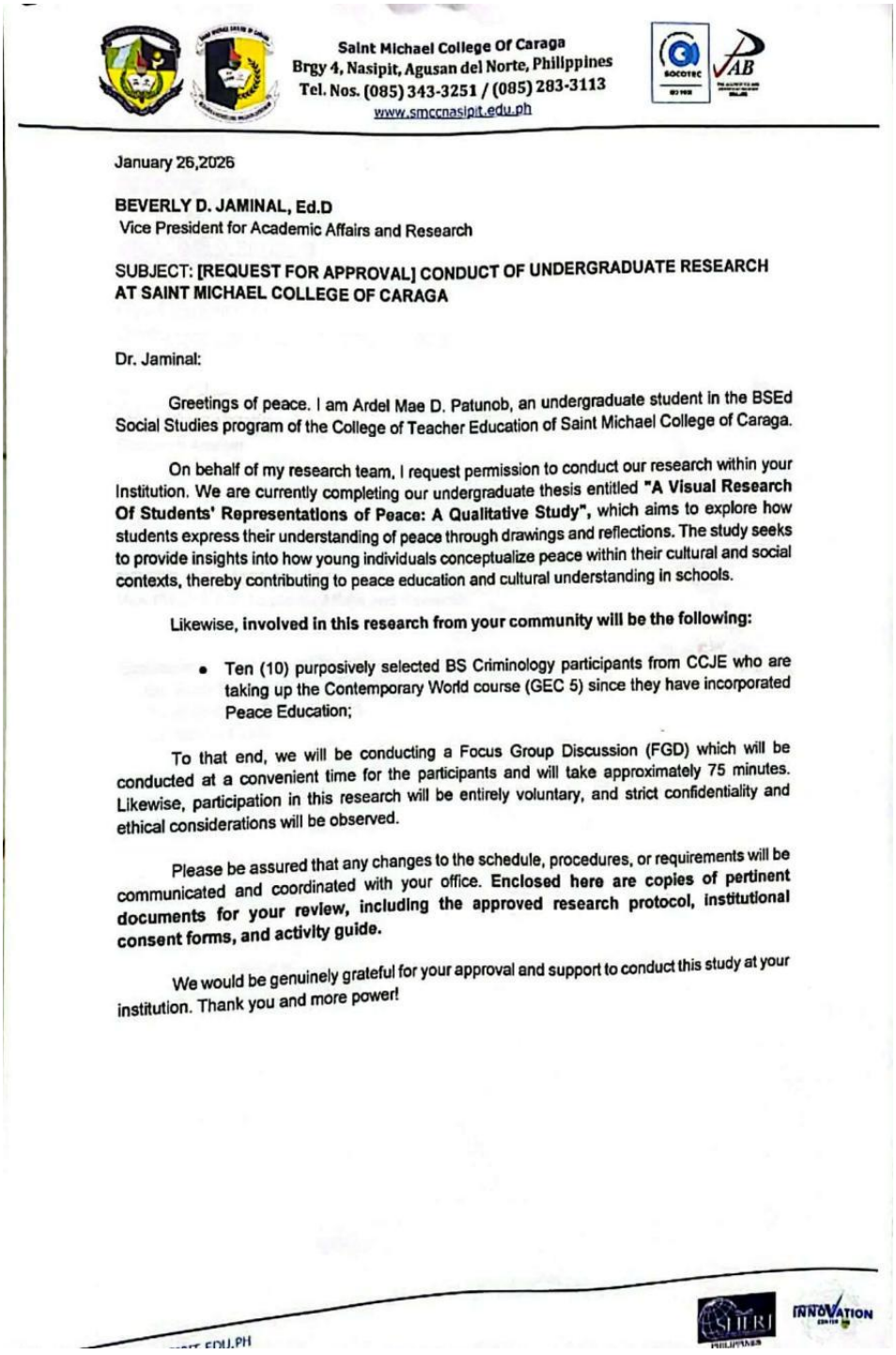
Elementary :
Secondary :
Tertiary :

Membership/Affiliations

ORGANIZATION	POSITIONS HELD

APPENDICES

A - Letter of Approval with Certificate of Appearance and Photo



Saint Michael College Of Caraga
Brgy 4, Nasipit, Agusan del Norte, Philippines
Tel. Nos. (085) 343-3251 / (085) 283-3113
www.smccnasipit.edu.ph

January 26,2026

BEVERLY D. JAMINAL, Ed.D
Vice President for Academic Affairs and Research

SUBJECT: **[REQUEST FOR APPROVAL] CONDUCT OF UNDERGRADUATE RESEARCH AT SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA**

Dr. Jaminal:

Greetings of peace. I am Ardel Mae D. Patunob, an undergraduate student in the BSEd Social Studies program of the College of Teacher Education of Saint Michael College of Caraga.

On behalf of my research team, I request permission to conduct our research within your Institution. We are currently completing our undergraduate thesis entitled **"A Visual Research Of Students' Representations of Peace: A Qualitative Study"**, which aims to explore how students express their understanding of peace through drawings and reflections. The study seeks to provide insights into how young individuals conceptualize peace within their cultural and social contexts, thereby contributing to peace education and cultural understanding in schools.

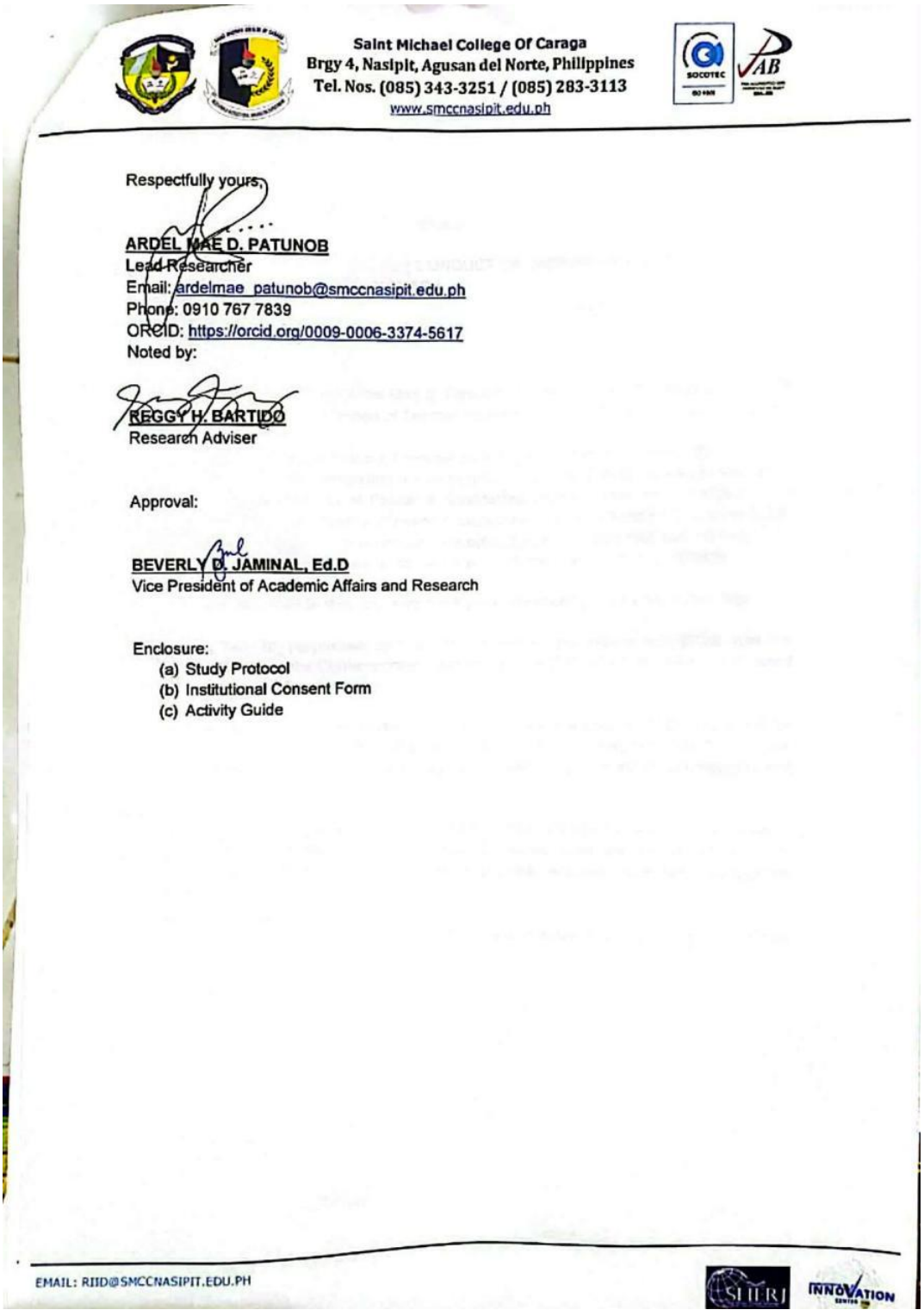
Likewise, **involved in this research from your community will be the following:**

- Ten (10) purposively selected BS Criminology participants from CCJE who are taking up the Contemporary World course (GEC 5) since they have incorporated Peace Education;

To that end, we will be conducting a Focus Group Discussion (FGD) which will be conducted at a convenient time for the participants and will take approximately 75 minutes. Likewise, participation in this research will be entirely voluntary, and strict confidentiality and ethical considerations will be observed.

Please be assured that any changes to the schedule, procedures, or requirements will be communicated and coordinated with your office. **Enclosed here are copies of pertinent documents for your review, including the approved research protocol, institutional consent forms, and activity guide.**

We would be genuinely grateful for your approval and support to conduct this study at your institution. Thank you and more power!



Saint Michael College Of Caraga
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Respectfully yours,

ARDEL MAE D. PATUNOB
Lead Researcher
Email: ardelmae_patunob@smccnasipit.edu.ph
Phone: 0910 767 7839
ORCID: https://orcid.org/0009-0006-3374-5617
Noted by:

REGGY H. BARTIDO
Research Adviser

Approval:

BEVERLY D. JAMINAL, Ed.D
Vice President of Academic Affairs and Research

Enclosure:
(a) Study Protocol
(b) Institutional Consent Form
(c) Activity Guide

EMAIL: RIID@SMCCNASIPIT.EDU.PH

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January 26, 2026

JUN VILLARMIA, Ph.D.
Dean, College of Criminal Justice Education
This Institution

SUBJECT: **[REQUEST FOR APPROVAL] CONDUCT OF FGD WITH SELECT BS CRIM STUDENTS**

Dean Villamia:

Greetings of peace. I am Ardel Mae D. Patunob, an undergraduate student of the BSEd Social Studies program from the College of Teacher Education. On behalf of my research team, I request your esteemed office's authorization for the conduct of the activities pertinent to our undergraduate thesis.

Our research is entitled, **"A Visual Research Of Students' Representations of Peace: A Qualitative Study."** This study aims to explore how students conceptualize and express their understanding of peace through visual representations (drawings) and subsequent reflections.

Likewise, involved in this research will be from your community:

- Ten (10) purposively selected **BS Criminology students from CCJE** currently enrolled in the **Contemporary World course (GEC 5)** since they have incorporated Peace Education;

To that end, we will be conducting a Focus Group Discussion (FGD) which will be conducted at a convenient time for the participants and will take approximately 75 minutes. Likewise, participation in this research will be entirely voluntary, and strict confidentiality and ethical considerations will be observed.

Enclosed here are copies of pertinent documents for your review, including the approved research protocol, institutional consent forms, and pertinent approvals from the School President, and approval from the Dean of our College for the initiation of data collection.

We would be genuinely grateful for your approval and support to conduct this study at your institution. Thank you and more power!

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Respectfully yours,

ARDEL MAE D. PATUNOB
Lead Researcher
Email: ardelmae_patunob@smccnasipit.edu.ph
Phone: 0910 767 7839
ORCID: https://orcid.org/0009-0006-3374-5617

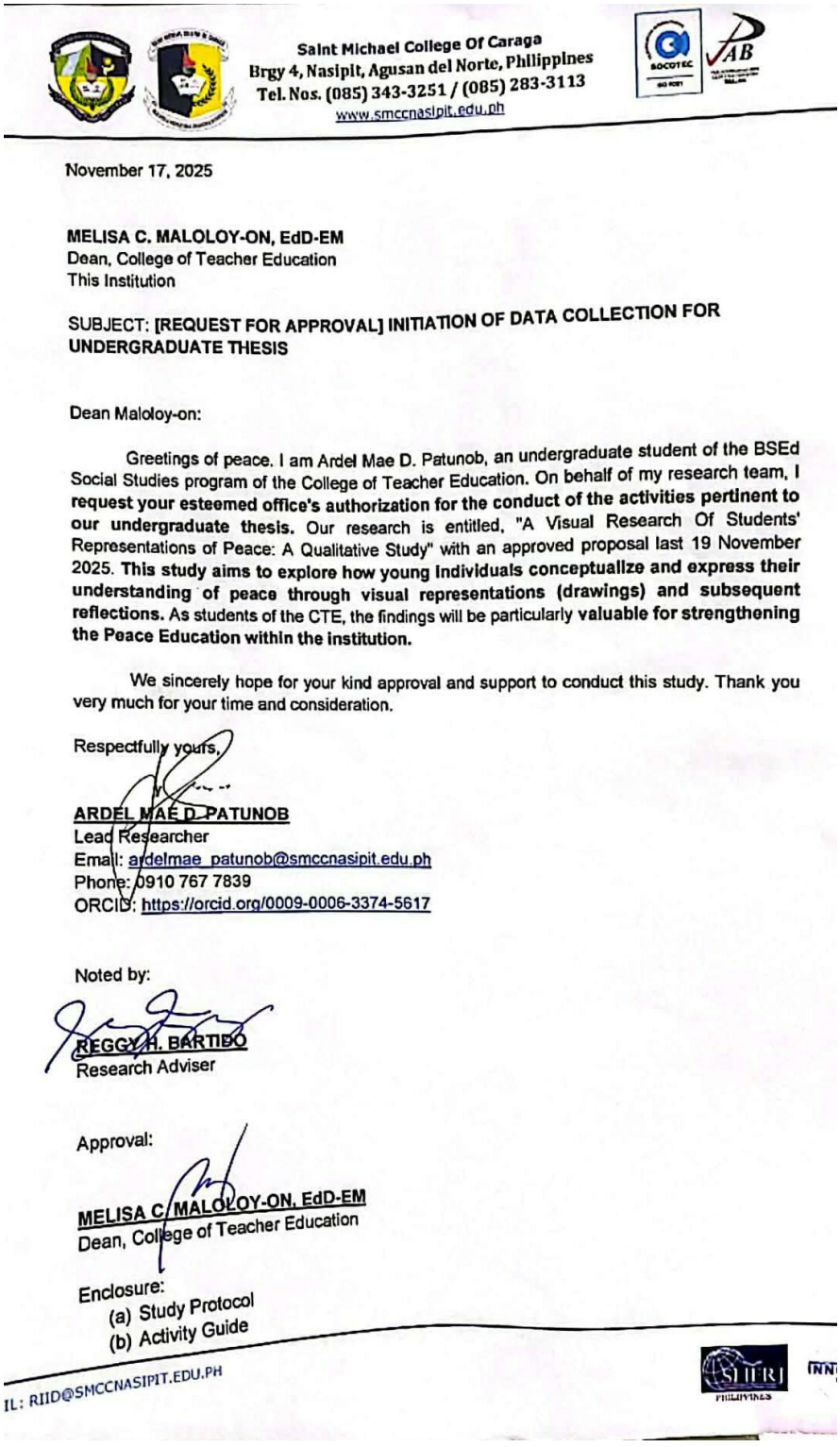
Noted by:

REGGY H. BARTIDO
Research Adviser

Approval:

JUN VILLARMIA, Ph.D.
Dean, College of Criminal Justice Education

Enclosure:
(a) Study Protocol
(b) Institutional Consent Form
(c) Activity Guide
(d) Approval from the CTE Dean
(e) Approval from the School President



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November 17, 2025

MELISA C. MALOLOY-ON, EdD-EM
Dean, College of Teacher Education
This Institution

SUBJECT: **[REQUEST FOR APPROVAL] INITIATION OF DATA COLLECTION FOR UNDERGRADUATE THESIS**

Dean Maloloy-on:

Greetings of peace. I am Ardel Mae D. Patunob, an undergraduate student of the BSEd Social Studies program of the College of Teacher Education. On behalf of my research team, I **request your esteemed office's authorization for the conduct of the activities pertinent to our undergraduate thesis.** Our research is entitled, "A Visual Research Of Students' Representations of Peace: A Qualitative Study" with an approved proposal last 19 November 2025. **This study aims to explore how young individuals conceptuallize and express their understanding of peace through visual representations (drawings) and subsequent reflections.** As students of the CTE, the findings will be particularly **valuable for strengthening the Peace Education within the institution.**

We sincerely hope for your kind approval and support to conduct this study. Thank you very much for your time and consideration.

Respectfully yours,

ARDEL MAE D. PATUNOB
Lead Researcher
Email: ardelmae_patunob@smccnasipit.edu.ph
Phone: 0910 767 7839
ORCID: https://orcid.org/0009-0006-3374-5617

Noted by:

REGGY H. BARTIDO
Research Adviser

Approval:

MELISA C. MALOLOY-ON, EdD-EM
Dean, College of Teacher Education

Enclosure:
(a) Study Protocol
(b) Activity Guide

IL: RIID@SMCCNASIPIT.EDU.PH

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November 17, 2025

ROLLY D. LLANOS, MAEd-SST
OIC-Dean, College of Arts and Sciences
This Institution

SUBJECT: **[REQUEST FOR APPROVAL] CONDUCT OF FGD WITH SELECT GEC 5 STUDENTS**

Dean Llanos:

Greetings of peace. I am Ardel Mae D. Patunob, an undergraduate student of the BSEd Social Studies program from the College of Teacher Education. On behalf of my research team, I request your esteemed office's authorization for the conduct of the activities pertinent to our undergraduate thesis.

Our research is entitled, **"A Visual Research Of Students' Representations of Peace: A Qualitative Study."** This study aims to explore how students conceptualize and express their understanding of peace through visual representations (drawings) and subsequent reflections.

Likewise, **involved in this research will be from your community:**

- **Ten (10) purposively selected BS Criminology students from CCJE currently enrolled in the Contemporary World course (GEC 5) since they have incorporated Peace Education;**

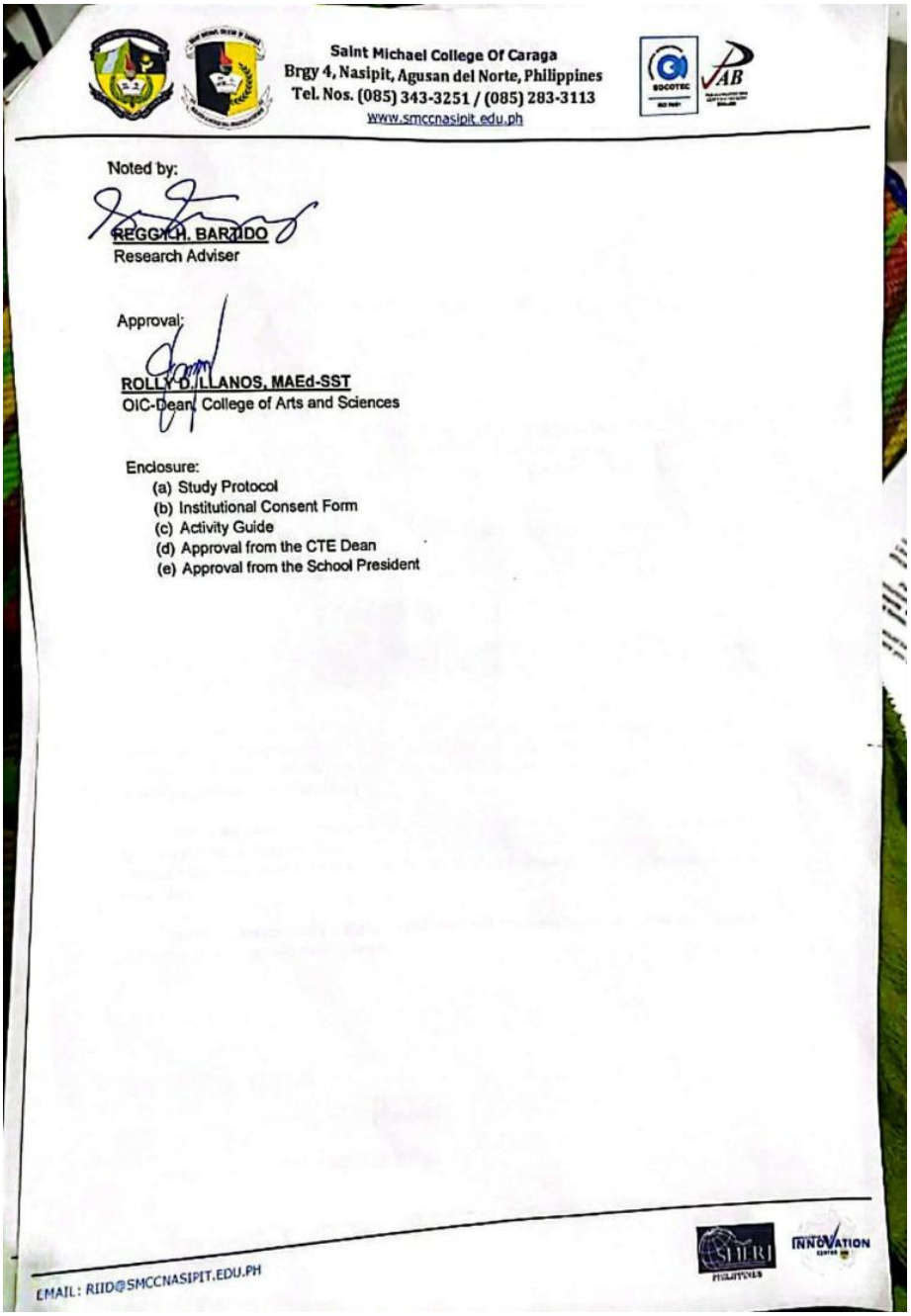
To that end, we will be conducting a Focus Group Discussion (FGD) which will be conducted at a convenient time for the participants and will take approximately 75 minutes. Likewise, participation in this research will be entirely voluntary, and strict confidentiality and ethical considerations will be observed.

Enclosed here are copies of pertinent documents for your review, including the approved research protocol, institutional consent forms, and pertinent approvals from the School President, and approval from the Dean of our College for the initiation of data collection.

We would be genuinely grateful for your approval and support to conduct this study at your institution. Thank you and more power!

Respectfully yours,

ARDEL MAE D. PATUNOB
Lead Researcher
Email: ardelmae_patunob@smccnasipit.edu.ph
Phone: 0910 767 7839
ORCID: https://orcid.org/0009-0006-3374-5617



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Noted by:

REGGY H. BARRIDO
Research Adviser

Approval:

ROLLY D. LLANOS, MAEd-SST
OIC-Dean, College of Arts and Sciences

Enclosure:
(a) Study Protocol
(b) Institutional Consent Form
(c) Activity Guide
(d) Approval from the CTE Dean
(e) Approval from the School President

EMAIL: RIID@SMCCNASIPIT.EDU.PH

B - Instrument with Informed Consent

PART 1: DEMOGRAPHIC INFORMATION SHEET

Please provide the following information to help contextualize your responses. All data will be kept confidential.

1. Full Name (for documentation only; will be coded for analysis): _____

2. Sex: [ ] Male
[ ] Female
[ ] Prefer not to say

3. Age: _____

4.Residential Area (e.g., urban, rural, barangay name): _____

4. How long have you been living here? _____

5. Have you taken any prior courses related to social peace? before The Contemporary World?
[ ] Yes
[ ] No

If yes, please list briefly: _____

PART 2: VISUAL EXPRESSION TOOL

INSTRUCTIONS FOR PARTICIPANTS:

· You will be given 45 minutes to create a drawing that represents your own perspectives ad experiences related to social peace. After completing the drawing activity, you will participate in a guided reflection and Focus group discussion. During this session, you will be asked to explain your drawing and share your thoughts and experiences using the guide questions.

· You will be provided with the following materials such as drawing paper, a set of colored pencils, markers, and erasers.

· You do not need to have any artistic training or skill. The goal is not to create a "perfect" drawing, but to visually express your own understanding of peace.

· You may use symbols, colors, images, or any visual elements that feel meaningful to you.

· Once you have completed your drawing, write a brief title for it at the top of the paper.

MATERIALS PROVIDED CHECKLIST:

☐ Bond paper

☐ Colored pencils (full set)

☐ Eraser

☐ Pencil

ARTWORK TITLE: _____

PART 4: GUIDED REFLECTION INSTRUMENT

Please respond to each question as thoroughly as possible. You may speak your responses (to be audio-recorded) or write them below. There are no "right" or "wrong" answers–we want to understand your unique perspective.

1. Please describe your drawing in your own words

2. What does each element in your drawing represent to you? For example, why did you choose a particular color, symbol, or image to stand for peace?

3. How does your artworks relate your ideas of social peace?

4. Does your drawing reflect any aspects of your cultural background, community values, or personal life experiences? If yes, please explain.

5. How do you think your understanding of peace might influence your future work as a criminology professional?

6. Is there anything else about your drawing or your idea of peace that you would like to share?

PART 4: DATA COLLECTION LOG

· Participant Code: _____

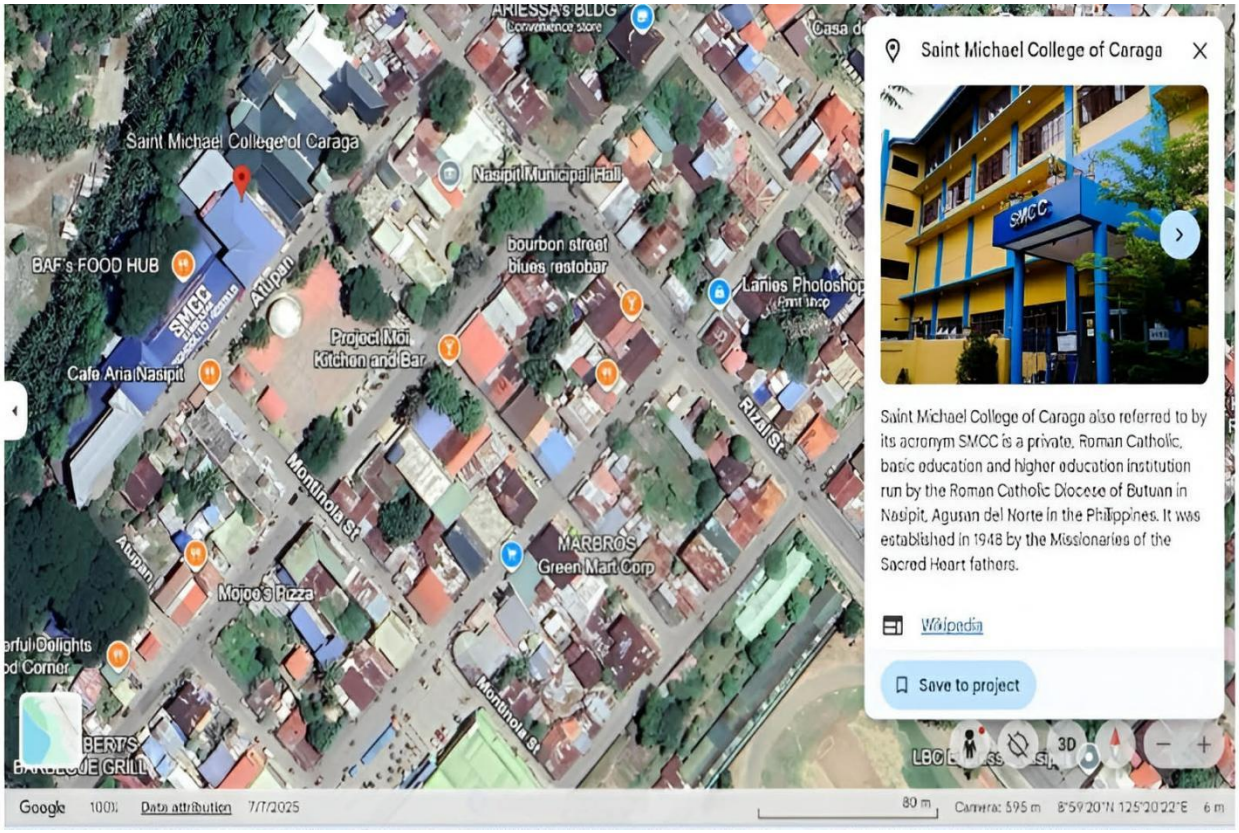
· Date and Time of Session: _____

· Location of Session: _____

· Materials Used (if different from standard): _____

· Audio Recording Status:
[ ] Recorded
[ ] Not Recorded (written responses submitted)

C - Map of the Research Locale (Include Coordinates)



D - Narrative & Photo Documentation



This photo shows the researchers working together to formulate a research title. The researchers made sure that the connection of the ideas will align with the research purpose.



This photo was taken during the meeting which the researchers discussed their research plan and ideas, including the topic and the procedures to be undertaken in conducting the study.



This photo was captured during the meeting organized by our research adviser, where we presented our ideas through a power point presentation. During the meeting the adviser provided suggestions and guidance on what should be included, as well as the procedures to be followed in the conduct of our study.



This photo was captured when we went to our Research Adviser for thorough checking and validation of our manuscript, research instrument, and baseline forms. During the consultation, the adviser carefully reviewed each document to ensure clarity, accuracy, and alignment. Feedback and recommendations were provided for necessary revisions to improve the reliability of the research



This photo was captured when we went to the Dean of College of Criminal Justice Education to request approval, as the participants of the study are under the jurisdiction of the college. The visit was conducted to formally seek permission to proceed with the data gathering and ensure compliance with institutional requirements.



This photo was captured when we went to our Research adviser to seek confirmation regarding to the contents of the letters and to ensure that all the required information was accurate.



This photo was captured during the visit to the Dean of College of Teacher Education office for the purpose of formally informing the administration about the conduct of our approved undergraduate thesis, in compliance with institutional research protocols.

E- Ethics Committee Approval

CERTIFICATE OF AUTHENTIC AUTHORSHIP

This is to certify that I/we, the undersigned author(s), have solely and honestly written the entire paper titled: "A VISUAL RESEARCH REPRESENTATION OF PEACE" All contents, ideas, data, and analysis presented in this paper are the results of my/our own diligent work and intellectual effort. The paper has been crafted to the best of my/our abilities, in full compliance with academic integrity standards and ethical research practices.

I/We further declare that:

1. This paper is free from any form of plagiarism or copyright infringement.

2. All referenced materials have been properly cited, and due credit has been given to the original authors and sources.

3. The work does not contain any falsified or fabricated data or information.

I/We acknowledge that if any rules or laws related to copyright, plagiarism, or other related legal or ethical standards are violated, Saint Michael College of Caraga shall not be held accountable for my/our actions. Any legal, academic, or ethical consequences arising from such violations shall solely be my/our responsibility.

Signed this

Date: January 5, 2025

Location: Saint Michael College of Caraga

Author(s):

Ardel Mae D. Patunob
Author

Anthony Van M. Turla
Author

Cyrose M. Bucad.
Author

Lorenajean B. Ducena
Author

Marie Claire C. Baclayon
Author